



PROGRESS REPORT

Data protection: progress report, September 2025 – September 2026

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54 countries. Each row below is carried verbatim from that country's own progress report, which answers a fixed frame of indicators over the period; nothing is written here. A country not listed under an indicator has **No evidence** on it in its own report.

DATA PROTECTION AUTHORITY · NATIONAL DATA PROTECTION READINESS

Progress values. *Movement* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a reported position worsened. *Mixed* — the indicator's instruments moved in different directions in the period; the clause after the comma names which moved which way. *No change* — the base holds a standing position and nothing in the period touched it. *No evidence* — the base holds nothing on this indicator at all. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Movement, regulations still pending*.

Data protection authority

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Algeria	The authority ruled that images are personal data and ran a compliance push; no enforcement decision is held. The authority was operating with no enforcement decision held at the window's opening, and ran a compliance push on officers, processing registers and audit logs from December 2025, alongside the national police on digital-space data protection and under continental review. Still no enforcement decision or penalty is held. 2026-07-15 - deliberation no. 04 treats images as personal data; its article 6 holds that publishing images via platforms hosted, storing or processing data, or reachable, from outside the country is a transfer of data outside national territory, and its article 11 provides that it takes effect on publication on the Authority's own website with no gazette step, twelve members being named.	MOVEMENT in activity rather than in enforcement
Angola	The authority published a third fine in August 2026, reaching commercial controllers outside the technology sector, with three of seven board seats filled. Enforcement is the movement. 2026-06-26 — millionaire fines were applied to two technology firms, and 2026-08-19 — a US\$115,000 penalty followed against a hotel, which is the first published sanction against an ordinary commercial controller outside the technology sector. These follow a 2024 wave that included the incumbent telecoms operator. Deliberation texts and dates are not published and the newest penalty is reported in dollars rather than kwanza, so no running total can be stated in one currency. Its constitution is the standing weakness. Three of the seven board seats are filled and the four the National Assembly and the judiciary elect are not established as ever having been filled; every member is removable by presidential decree at any time and without stated grounds; and the body retains 60% of the fines and fees it levies, revenue onto which a pay decree moved most of each board member's salary from May 2024.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Benin	The authority examined 907 files and sanctioned 14 cases in 2025, and required extraneous fields stripped from the electoral roll before publication. 2026-06-25 — the 2025 report records 907 files examined with 87.4% validated, 782 contentious, 64 control missions, 75 conformity certificates, 37 data-protection officers and 14 sanctioned cases. The authority flags its own gaps as the absence of algorithmic-audit tooling and of budget, and it was created by the digital code. 2026-05-16 — it required extraneous fields to be stripped from the electoral roll before publication, resolving a transparency-against-privacy question by regulatory decision rather than by legislation. Its statutory reporting is the weak point. One activity report covering 2015 to 2020 was published under the digital code and nothing later is held, so a duty that is statutory has produced one document in a decade — against an annual compliance report that does exist.	MOVEMENT in caseload
Botswana	The commission suspended a government payslip portal by enforcement notice in July 2026, a year after operating with three contract officers and no premises. The starting position was an authority that barely existed: three contract officers, no premises, no published address, no website and no deputy commissioner in July 2025. 2026-02-11 — it began enforcing against non-bank financial institutions, and 2026-07-17 — it issued a determination and enforcement notice against the public service management directorate, suspending the government payslip portal with compliance evidence due within a month. The directorate published a privacy notice on 6 July, completed an impact assessment on 13 July and added multi-factor authentication and a disaster-recovery plan, with no reopening date. The determination itself is not held; both accounts are press carries. It is the first published enforcement against a government body on this ledger, and the regulator still has no budget organisation or line of its own.	MOVEMENT
Burkina Faso	The commission was superseded by a merger vote on 3 August 2026 having never had repressive powers, its appropriation down 43% over two years and no annual report published. 2026-08-03 — an organic law voted the same day merges the broadcasting regulator created in 1995 and the data-protection commission instituted in 2004 into a single authority with its own rule-making power and staggered renewal of its first college, placed under the revised Constitution of January 2026, reported as a merger of the two bodies. No commencement, seat or leadership is stated, and nothing on file establishes how its independence, budget or appointment route is secured. What it replaces never worked. The commission operated with no repressive powers, its standing borrowed from a prime-ministerial compliance campaign, and it was superseded having never received the enforcement decrees it asked for. Its 2024 report was validated in plenary in June 2025 and still not found published a year later, against a statutory duty. The money moved the same way: FCFA 490m for 2026 against FCFA 857m in 2024, a 43% fall over two years while the remit expands.	MIXED a successor authority with rule-making power voted while the existing commission was superseded without ever receiving its enforcement decrees
Burundi	The data protection authority was created by the January 2026 law, with no appointment, budget or decision on file since. The January 2026 data protection law provides for an independent supervisory authority. Seven months on, no appointment, budget, seat or decision appears on the record, so the body exists in statute and not in operation. That gap matters here more than usual. The biometric identity card, the digital civil registry and the instant payment system are all being built inside the same period, and the authority that would supervise their processing has not been constituted. The only consumer-facing enforcement on this ledger came from the telecommunications regulator instead, reported under payments consumer protection.	MOVEMENT
Cameroon	The authority is created in law, not established and unfunded, with no appropriation in the FY2025 or FY2026 estimates. The authority was created by the December 2024 statute as an independent public body, so the function does not sit with the existing information technology agency, and it is not established. No appropriation for it appears in the FY2025 or FY2026 estimates; the statute's only appearance in a finance law is a tax derogation from it. Nothing in the window named a president, a seat, a staff or a commencement decree, so a data-protection law has been in force for the whole window with nobody empowered to apply it.	NO CHANGE

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Cape Verde	The commission's powers are unchanged and its appropriation stands at CVE 36,313,115 for FY2025, with FY2026 unestablished. The commission has been an independent supervisory authority since 2015-16, with fining powers and referral of possible criminal matters to the public prosecution, and is a member of the Global Privacy Assembly. Its president stated it was entering a phase more attentive to digital innovation and named retention of technical staff as a standing constraint, every technician who started in 2016 having left. It was appropriated CVE 36,313,115 for FY2025 inside the National Assembly's own private budget rather than through any ministerial vote, a 3.0% uplift on CVE 35,255,451 for FY2024, with zero own-source revenue in both years; against the fining powers the statute confers, that is roughly a dozen maximum penalties. The FY2026 volume contains no occurrence of the commission in 266 pages, so its FY2026 appropriation is unestablished. On its own site it has published no genuine activity report since 2016.	NO CHANGE
Central African Republic	The data protection authority is eighteen months past its statutory establishment deadline, its functions vesting in the supervising ministry meanwhile. A twelve-month statutory deadline for establishing the authority expired in January 2025 with no establishment recorded, and the statute vests its functions in the supervising ministry in the meantime. The law that creates it was promulgated in January 2024. Eighteen months past the deadline, nothing has moved. The sanction ceiling the unfilled body would wield is 5% of the last closed year's pre-tax turnover, so the gap between the regime on paper and the regime in operation is the whole of the enforcement. Data protection supervision therefore sits with the ministry that also sponsors the identity, payments and platform programmes reported in this document.	NO CHANGE
Chad	An ordinance reformed the security and electronic certification agency, placing data protection and artificial-intelligence governance inside it, and there is no separate data-protection authority. The Senate ratified after National Assembly approval (ordinance). The gazetted text is not held. The base records a vote count and an ordinance number that appear in no held source, which is stated here rather than repeated as fact. Data protection and artificial-intelligence governance sitting inside a security agency, with no independent authority and no statute to enforce, is the governance arrangement this unit has. It is the frame for the biometric register, the subscriber-data interconnection and the police equipment transfer recorded below.	MOVEMENT
Comoros	The authority is still not created five years after the statute, its establishment financed entirely by external lenders. It has been provided for in law since 29 June 2021 and never constituted. 2026-03-12 - institutional capacity and a stand-up consultancy were procured under the e-government project, with submissions open to 12 March 2027 and no domestic appropriation attached; creating the authority is also a stated component of the continental bank's digitisation project. Five years from statute to procurement notice, with no operating date on file and the supervisor of Comorian personal data to be paid for by two foreign lenders.	NO CHANGE a stand-up consultancy has now been procured
Congo	The data protection commission was installed on 22 January 2026 after members were appointed by decree of 31 December 2025. A bill creating the commission was approved in council of ministers in July 2024, with no members appointed and the body not constituted. 2026-01-22 - members appointed by decree of 31 December 2025 held the inaugural session and elected a president, vice-president and rapporteur, with powers stated as advising, warning and sanctioning. Installation is the whole of it: no decision, sanction, registration regime, guidance, budget or annual report is on file in the six months since, and nothing states whether controllers must register or notify, what fees or deadlines apply, or whether any enforcement has occurred.	MOVEMENT installation is the whole of the movement

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Cote d'Ivoire	The regulator is confirmed as the data-protection authority and created a register of officers, but publishes no annual report. The regulator is confirmed as the data-protection authority, with no separable data-protection appropriation identifiable. 2026-05-18 - the minister's stocktake named a register of data-protection officers, created in 2026, alongside simplified norms; no register size, publication or legal basis is stated. Against that, no 2024 or 2025 activity report is published on the regulator's site and the most recent locatable edition anywhere is 2022, across two automated attempts. The only throughput figure held is about a hundred physical compliance files a month immediately before the online platform went live. Publication of the 2024 report is the only route on file to whether the function has a separable budget.	MIXED a register of data-protection officers was created while the authority's annual report has not appeared since 2022
Djibouti	The supervisory commission established by the Digital Code has no record of its constitution, membership, register or decisions. The commission is established by the Digital Code, and the base holds no record of its constitution, membership, register or decisions at either end of the window. Thirteen months after a code of about eight hundred articles took effect, the body that would enforce its data-protection volume cannot be shown to exist. The public register of processing the same code provides for is therefore also unevidenced, and the prior-authorisation regime has no authority on record to grant an authorisation.	NO CHANGE
DR Congo	A network of data-protection officers launched in March 2026, while the authority required by article 262 is still not created. The authority is required by article 262 of the code and the decree defining its organisation and functioning was never drafted or signed, leaving the body non-operational - now two years of the same finding, running alongside a twenty-year exclusive foreign concession over citizens' identity data. It was named again in July 2026 as a link in the cybersecurity chain. 2026-03-12 - a national network of data-protection officers was launched with two civil-society bodies, framed as alignment with the continental convention. It is the first concrete step under article 262 since 2023, and it moves the enforcement gap without closing it: a professional network is not a supervisor with sanctioning powers.	MIXED a national network of data-protection officers was launched while the authority the code requires is still not created
Egypt	The supervisory centre was confirmed by the Executive Regulations and published ten compliance guidelines; no regulator decision is held. The base carries no dated statement of the Centre's standing, staffing or activity at the window's opening. It is confirmed as the body implementing, monitoring and enforcing the law, running the approvals and cross-border-transfer licensing regime, officer registration and breach receipt, its acting chief executive having framed data sovereignty as a strategic necessity at a November 2025 workshop. 2026-01 to 02 - ten guidelines were published covering consent, lawful bases, electronic direct marketing, the data protection officer, officer categories, data users, principles, records of processing, licences and permits, and privacy notices, with breach-notification and records templates. Enforcement is one court award: EGP 10 million ordered against an operator in February 2025 on tort and custodian's liability, not on the data-protection law. No regulator decision, fine, registration figure or transfer licence is on record at any date.	MOVEMENT
Equatorial Guinea	The supervisory body the statute provides for was never created: article 15 leaves it to a decree the government has not issued. The article leaves both the supervisory organ and the registry it would run to that decree, and a continental country register records no supervisory authority publicly identified (the law). So a statute with a sanctions regime running to CFA 15,000,000 (the law) has had no body able to apply it for ten years, which is the clearest instance on this ledger of a law without an institution.	NO CHANGE
Eritrea	No data-protection law and no authority. A legal survey and a regional policy matrix agree that neither exists. There is nothing to supervise and no one to supervise it. A legal survey records no data-protection statute, and a regional policy matrix places the country at the nascent end of its own scale. A digital trade regulatory profile reaches the same finding from a different direction. The absence has consequences elsewhere on this ledger. Without an authority there is no route for a complaint about personal data, no body that could authorise a transfer out of the country, and nothing that could act on synthetic or manipulated media. Each of those reads as a separate gap; all of them are this one.	NO CHANGE

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Eswatini	The authority opened its first major investigation, into a ministry that published unblurred national identity documents and missed the 72-hour breach-notification duty. The investigation was opened in June 2026, following an awareness campaign in February and a lender assessment naming digital transformation as key to growth (investigation, campaign, assessment). The breach was the ministry's own publication of unblurred identity documents, and it missed the statutory 72-hour notification (breach). The ICT ministry stated on the record that implementation, enforcement and oversight are vested in the regulator and not in itself, which settles the mandate question in practice even as the statute's naming of the body remains unresolved (mandate). A first investigation opening against a government ministry, rather than a private controller, is the strongest single fact about this authority in the record. The authority has used its powers: three enforcement notices under section 41 of the Act are published, two in June 2024 against a mobile operator and an insurer and one in March 2025 against the science and technology park. No register of complaints, breach notifications or registered controllers accompanies them.	MOVEMENT
Ethiopia	The communications authority is the designated regulator, and a year after commencement it had taken no enforcement action. The proclamation names the Ethiopian Communications Authority as regulator rather than creating a dedicated body (Proclamation 1321/2024). A year after commencement the authority had yet to enforce and public awareness was low, on a base where the national identity authenticates about 4m times a day across more than 150 agencies (a year on). No budget, staffing figure, register of controllers or decision of any kind is held for the authority in its data-protection role.	NO CHANGE
Gabon	The data protection authority has two dated acts on record, a supervised file destruction and a pre-commissioning clearance for the national data centre. The authority supervised the destruction of unsuccessful bidders' files on 20 January 2026 (file destruction) and announced pre-commissioning compliance clearance for the national data centre on 9 June 2026 after several months of accompaniment (compliance clearance). In September 2026 its president set out the mandate and its limits: a regulatory power to publish rules in the official journal, personal data remaining the citizen's property while collectors process it, and insult and digital communication falling to the media regulator; he put dealing directly with the large social platforms as needing a common African response. Independence is asserted rather than evidenced by a budget, staffing or caseload figure. It was created by article 7 of the 2023 statute and is funded by a levy of 1,000 FCFA per person per year split 40 per cent to the state and 60 per cent to the authority (funding levy). No register of authorisations, declarations or sanctions is published, and both acts are known only from press accounts.	MOVEMENT
Gambia	The Information Commission carries both the access and the data-protection statutes, and is receiving donor support to raise awareness of them. The support is funded under a peacebuilding project to build a communication strategy raising public awareness of the two Acts (support). No budget, staffing, caseload or enforcement record for the commission is held, and awareness-raising support is not evidence of enforcement capacity. It is one body carrying two statutes, one of them enacted only in 2025.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Ghana	The regulator declared 2026 a year of enforcement, brought a fee schedule into force and bought field vehicles, and has still published no fine. It operates from a single head office with a size-banded fee schedule in force from 2 February 2026, two field-enforcement vehicles bought from internally generated funds, and regional offices intended in five regions by the end of 2026 with none yet opened (vehicles). Children's data, health data and national-security-relevant data are the named enforcement priorities (enforcement year), and a new governing board was sworn in tasked with a national data-governance framework (board). Twelve months on, no fine, prosecution or registered-controller count has been published and the only quantities published are awareness ones (enforcement record). An upgrade of the regulator to an authority was announced in August 2025 with no bill, timetable or further mention in the twelve months since (upgrade). 2026-09-07 - the Commission's own first-half figures reach the base for the first time: a 51.5 per cent rise in regulatory activity and a 98.4 per cent rise in newly registered data controllers over the first half of 2026, with its public campaign put at an estimated 25 million people reached. The controller registration rate is a growth figure without the base it grew from, and still no fine or prosecution is published.	MOVEMENT
Guinea	The authority exists in law and has never been constituted: ten years after the statute provided for it there are no appointed members, no organising decree and no website. The 2016 statute provides for the authority's creation by regulation and repeatedly assigns functions to it. 2024-06-20 - the transition council's permanent commissions met in inter-commission with officials from the prime minister's office, the telecommunications and justice ministries and the government secretariat on the bill establishing the authority; councillors raised concerns over the designation of members, their mandates and the absence of the diaspora, and those observations had to be addressed before plenary examination and adoption. Nothing located since shows that changed. The national digitalisation strategy still carries establishing and operationalising the authority as an initiative to be done, and the functions the statute assigns it — authorising transfers to third countries among them — have no one to exercise them.	STALLED
Guinea-Bissau	A National Cybersecurity and Data Protection Agency was committed to in January 2025; nothing on the base confirms it exists. 2025-01-22 — the government presented the results of a WARDIP cybersecurity feasibility study and committed to creating a National Cybersecurity and Data Protection Agency, framed by the minister responsible as central to data protection and digital sovereignty. The commitment predates the window and no source since confirms the agency established, staffed or operational. The country therefore has no supervisory authority on the record, and the draft data governance and protection decree approved in July 2025 is not confirmed in force either, so neither the body nor the instrument it would enforce is in place.	NO CHANGE
Kenya	The regulator took a first separate appropriation of KSh 917.3m, on a caseload last stated at 7,128 complaints in March 2025. The appropriation is projected to KSh 1,328m by 2028/29, and through FY2025/26 the regulator had no separately visible line (appropriation). The caseload figure carries 215 determinations, and the regulator self-reports 97 per cent of complaints resolved, penalties on 10 entities, 103 compensations and 39 alternative-dispute resolutions (caseload); no later caseload, determination count or penalty total has been published (caseload, restatement). A five-year privacy plan launched at KES 12.6bn in July 2025 has produced no spend, milestone or progress statement since (plan), and a quality management system launched in July 2026 with donor support still awaits its external certification audit (quality system). No national count of registered controllers and processors exists at any date; only the betting-sector subset is held (registration). The regulator gave data controllers and processors holding expired registration certificates 14 days to renew or face enforcement action, in a notice of 28 August 2026 (notice).	MIXED the regulator gained its first separate appropriation while its published caseload has not moved in eighteen months
Lesotho	The Data Protection Commission is provided for by the 2011 Act but no commissioner had been appointed as at March 2026. The commission exists in law and not in fact: the 2011 Act provides for it, and the most recent account held records no commissioner appointed as at 23 March 2026 (review). Fifteen years after the statute, the base holds no appointment, no budget line, no staff and no supervisory decision from it.	NO CHANGE

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Liberia	The telecoms regulator fined an operator LRD 4m for issuing a subscriber's module to a third party, the first privacy penalty on the record. It was imposed by the telecoms regulator rather than under data-protection law, which had none in force at the time (fine). The reform package announced the same month does not name a data-protection function (package), and no data-protection authority exists to which such a case could now be brought.	MOVEMENT
Libya	No supervisory authority exists and none is named in the strategy that targets a data-protection law, leaving new platforms to protect data on instruction alone. The National Artificial Intelligence Strategy sets a data-protection law for 2026 but does not name a regulator to administer it (strategy). The practical consequence shows in the Libya Experts Forum registration platform, reported ready for launch in July 2026: those preparing it were instructed to protect registrants' data, with no statute and no regulator to apply (platform).	NO CHANGE
Madagascar	The data-protection commission is provided for by the 2014 law and has never been constituted, its creation urged by an assessment mission in 2025. The commission exists in the statute and not in fact, and an assessment mission urged its creation in February 2025 (assessment). No later account is held: no appointment, budget line, premises or supervisory decision, which is why the data-protection law beside it is recorded as unenforced rather than as breached.	NO CHANGE
Malawi	The authority now operates as a unit inside the regulator with a named head, draft regulations and a registration fee schedule out for consultation, and independence stated as intended. The unit has a named head of data protection and a stated implementation framework, with no organogram, enforcement record or registration data published (unit). Draft regulations, guidelines and a turnover-based registration fee schedule ranging from MWK 50,000 for small and medium enterprises to MWK 7 million for the largest controllers of significant importance were published and consulted on before finalisation (fees); no commencement date is on record (fees, consultation). The regulator states it intends to establish both the authority and the response team as independent institutions with donor technical assistance, with no legislative vehicle, timetable or funding model on record (separation); a consultancy to design the authority's structure was tendered in October 2025 with no award on file (consultancy).	MOVEMENT
Mali	The data-protection authority opened its second 2026 session with more than 1,000 files, and has a regional antenna at Segou. The session opened on 3 August 2026 with more than 1,000 files before it over ten days, against about 2,000 declaratory files under review a year earlier and one fine of five million francs with more than 100 formal notices issued in 2025 (session, caseload). A regional antenna opened at Segou in December 2025 (antenna). No figures are published for sanctions issued or files cleared, so the workload is visible and the output is not. Cooperation with the Beninese authority was agreed in April 2025 with no joint action published since (cooperation).	MOVEMENT
Mauritania	The data protection authority is established and operating under a 2023-2026 plan, with no decision, register or annual report held. Its existence and plan are recorded by a reference guide (guide). Nine years after the statute, the base holds no decision, no register of declared processing, no enforcement action and no annual report from it, so what can be established is that the institution exists and not that it acts.	NO CHANGE
Mauritius	The office runs about 3,000 enforcement actions a year with 99 per cent resolved amicably, and is pursuing a European adequacy assessment. Enforcement volume was set out at an international identity meeting in May 2026: about 3,000 actions a year, 99 per cent resolved amicably, chief data officers mandated and administrative fines being added by amendment (enforcement, formula). Adequacy is being pursued with full alignment of the law to the European regulation, and no application date, assessment stage or decision is published (adequacy).	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Morocco	The commission runs a public national register of declared processing under the 2009 law and signed a cooperation memorandum with Portugal in February 2026. The data-protection authority set out in a communiqué of 28 August 2026 the rules binding political parties, candidates and artificial-intelligence-generated content during the legislative campaign (communiqué), having earlier set out the requirements for processing personal data in the elections (guidance). The national register was first published in January 2023, covering installations from the commission's own creation to the end of 2022, with a definitive-format version in February 2023 and a separate complaints and controls register public from March 2023, operating under articles 45 to 50 of the law (register). A cooperation memorandum with the Portuguese authority was signed on 8 February 2026, covering exchange of information and technical expertise on artificial intelligence, synthetic media and digital violence; the text is not held (memorandum).	MOVEMENT
Mozambique	The data protection authority exists only in the draft law, and donor funding for standing it up was cut from US\$18m to US\$11m in January 2026. No authority has been established: it is provided for in the draft only, with a two-tier commission and agency in the September 2025 version (review, preparation). A December 2025 diagnostic recommended creating one (diagnostic). In January 2026 the funder cut the project subcomponent covering cybersecurity and data protection from US\$18m to US\$11m, stating that operationalising the Data Protection Office had been envisaged over six years and the remaining project period no longer allows it (restructuring). Four institutions exercise implied oversight between them, with coordination gaps (inception).	STALLED
Namibia	A Data Protection Supervisory Authority sits at Part 2 of a draft bill that has not been tabled, and no authority exists. The draft's stated objects are establishing the authority with its own powers and duties, obligations on controllers and processors, rights for data subjects, and codes of conduct (draft, earlier version). A civil-society critique of the 2022 consultation argued the sections on the authority's independence need substantial redrafting. Four years on there is no authority, no commencement and no later text.	STALLED
Niger	The data protection authority operates under the 2022 statute, with no caseload or sanction figures published. The authority is operating and is the privacy backstop for the biometric identity programme (authority, profile). No caseload, register or sanction figure is published. A national biometric card capturing fingerprint, face, voice and iris is being enrolled while the supervisory record is empty.	NO CHANGE
Nigeria	The commission has taken compliance above 55 per cent on a remediation-first model, imposed a ₦766m penalty, opened multinational investigations and had a platform fund its capacity programme. Compliance lifted from about 4 per cent of organisations to above 55 per cent by March 2025 (enforcement); twenty-one-day notices went to 1,369 organisations in 2025 and more than a thousand educational institutions in 2026, and a forensic investigation was opened in August 2026 into a federal university, a bank and a technology vendor over students' data allegedly used to open bank accounts without consent (enforcement, schools, investigation). The Federal High Court upheld the power to designate and register controllers of major importance, reaching agents, banks, telcos, health and digital platforms (court). The largest fine to date, ₦766,242,500, was imposed expressly for want of cooperation, and whether it was paid, contested or varied is not established (fine). Multinational platforms are under investigation (probes), and a two-year capacity programme is funded under a court-approved settlement with a United States platform (settlement).	MOVEMENT
Rwanda	A supervisory authority is named under the 2021 law, and its appropriation held flat in 2026/27 at about US\$114,000 on the 2024/25 rate. The authority is the named supervisor under the law (authority, finance law). Its appropriation was held flat in the 2026/27 finance law, at about US\$114,000 on the 2024/25 exchange rate — a supervisory function for the whole economy funded at roughly the cost of a small office (appropriation, prior year, baseline). Nothing on file records an enforcement action, penalty or audit by it at any date.	NO CHANGE

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Sao Tome and Principe	The authority was assigned to supervise the civil-registry to electoral-database interconnection, and signed a cooperation memorandum with a Macau counterpart covering cross-border flows and artificial-intelligence supervision. Supervision of the interconnection was assigned in April 2026, which is the only instance in this base of a data-protection authority being given oversight of a specific interoperability project at the point it goes live (supervision). The memorandum was signed in June 2026 covering cross-border data flows, artificial-intelligence supervision, awareness, training and joint studies (memorandum, pacts). The authority is also a founding member of a recently created Lusophone data-protection network, hosted for a cooperation visit by the Portuguese commission (network). Its supervisory output — findings, penalties, registrations — is not published at any date.	MOVEMENT
Senegal	The authority published its first quarterly caseload the base holds — 195 files in the second quarter of 2026 — alongside a cooperation convention with no workplan behind it. The convention was signed at the counterpart's headquarters (convention). No workplan, budget or joint action has followed it. The authority operates under a law that has stood unamended since 2008 and did not move through the identity-directorate breach, so its cross-border cooperation is running ahead of its own domestic instrument. 2026-09-01 — the commission published a quarterly opinion for April to June 2026: 195 files handled, 154 declarations and 41 authorisation requests, producing 153 declaration receipts and 39 authorisations, with one processing operation rejected, two data controllers heard, eight complaints and one report (opinion). It is the first published measure of the authority's own throughput on this ledger, and it is a volume figure rather than an enforcement one.	MOVEMENT
Seychelles	The Information Commission names no clear power to enforce its orders as its own most urgent weakness, in its own reform whitepaper. The finding is the Commission's own, set out in its access-to-information reform whitepaper, and it marked data protection day in January 2026 (whitepaper, day). The same body holds both the access-to-information and the data-protection mandates, so the enforcement gap it identifies runs across both. A regulator publishing that it cannot enforce its own orders is unusually direct, and it is the fact that governs how much weight the fully-in-force statute above can carry.	MOVEMENT
Sierra Leone	Cabinet authorised repeal of the information commission Act and a merged dual-mandate authority covering data protection and access to information. The existing Right to Access Information Commission would be repealed and replaced by a single authority holding both mandates (merger). No establishing text, commencement date, budget or staffing is published. Until the Bill passes, the country has an access-to-information regulator and no data-protection regulator at all.	MOVEMENT
Somalia	The Data Protection Authority took its first nationwide enforcement step in June 2026, mandatory registration under the Act, and its independence is qualified by executive appointment and override powers. The authority was inaugurated in February 2024 and moved to mandatory registration of controllers and processors in June 2026 (enforcement, inauguration). Its independence is qualified by executive appointment and override powers, which is the standing limit on everything it does and is stated in the record rather than inferred. No registration count, penalty or completed investigation is published.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
South Africa	The regulator has issued four enforcement notices since May, the latest to the national bureau of standards, and took its school-results challenge to the Supreme Court of Appeal after three losses in the high court. 2026-05/06 — the regulator issued its first enforcement notice for 2026 in May, a precedent-setting access-to-information notice against a mining company in June, and a third treating a misdirected email as a reportable breach. 2026-08-31 — a fourth notice went to the national bureau of standards over its 2024 ransomware attack, giving it 90 days to revise policies, run personal-information impact assessments and implement security measures, the regulator finding it had processed personal information unlawfully. Two direct-marketing matters went to the enforcement committee under section 69, against more than 3,800 complaints in the previous year. 2026-08-17 — it lodged an appeal to the Supreme Court of Appeal over newspaper publication of school-leaving results, having lost three bids in the high court, arguing the education department must release results directly to learners. Against that, it has no capability to test external systems for privacy compliance before launch, on a reporting rail in place since April 2025. 2026-09-02 — the chair named the compliance grace period the Act's key weakness: a body that remedies a violation in time cannot then be fined, and the high-value fines since July 2021 have largely not materialised (briefing).	MOVEMENT
South Sudan	Not held, searched 2026-09-06 - the communications regulator carries information protection and data privacy among its functions in the absence of an authority. The authority's own overview describes its statutory mandate under the National Communication Act 2012 as including information protection and data privacy, alongside its telecommunications, broadcasting and postal regulatory role (overview). A civil-society organisation convened a two-day workshop in May 2026 with the regulator, members of parliament and the UN mission's legal unit to review and validate version 1.0 of the Data Protection Bill 2025 (workshop). A sector regulator holding a privacy function inside a telecoms mandate is not a data protection authority, and the argument that a bill alone would not create one is made separately in the research recorded elsewhere.	NO CHANGE
Sudan	A cybersecurity authority was launched in January 2026, and its published mandate is cybersecurity rather than personal-data protection. The authority created by the November 2025 decree was formally stood up in January 2026, mandated to lead national cybersecurity policy, regulatory frameworks and protection of digital infrastructure (launch). In May 2026 it asserted full Sudanese sovereignty over the national digital-identity platform, and named data governance, encryption-key management and periodic security review as national priorities (statement). No body with a personal-data protection remit is held, and the draft data law that would create one is not in force. A research series published in July 2026 reads the same gap from the other side (series).	MOVEMENT
Tanzania	The commission issued a seven-day completion ultimatum on registration and officer duties, and launched a certified data-protection officer programme with the open university. Inspections were announced to begin in April 2026 and the ultimatum followed in June; the base holds no count of registered controllers and no inspection outcome, fine or enforcement decision after that start date (ultimatum, inspections). The officer programme is the capacity answer to the statutory mandatory-officer duty, with no intake number, fee or first cohort date on file (programme). An inspection regime announced, an ultimatum issued and no outcome published is the enforcement position here.	MOVEMENT
Togo	The data-protection authority formally launched activities with a public campaign from April 2025, and signed a cooperation accord with the broadcasting authority. The authority was created by an article of the 2019 statute rather than by a separate constitutive act, launched activities at the capital, certified a first cohort of corporate correspondents and held a second edition of a personal-data forum in July 2026 (launch, correspondents, forum, edition). The accord with the broadcasting authority was signed in December 2025; the sole account is sourced to the data-protection authority itself and carries no critical framing of that access (accord). No enforcement action, penalty, complaint volume or registration count is published at any date.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Tunisia	The national data-protection authority was cited by the replacement bill's own sponsors as institutionally limited. The characterisation is the sponsors', made in February 2026 as part of the case for the new organic law (authority). No enforcement action, penalty, complaint volume or registration figure for the authority is published at any date. A legislature's own sponsors naming the regulator as the reason for replacing the statute is the strongest statement about it in the record.	NO CHANGE
Uganda	The protection office confirmed compliance by a global messaging platform in July 2026, and its earlier orders against a search company have no recorded compliance step. The messaging decision was made in February 2026 and compliance confirmed by a letter of July 2026, which is correspondence and is not held (compliance, decision). The orders against the search company were decided in July 2025 with thirty days to register and file cross-border evidence; the precedent travelled and the compliance step was never recorded (orders, breach). A six-month awareness campaign launched in December 2025 targeted reaching 70 per cent of the population and registering 1,000 controllers (campaign). Two decisions against global platforms, one confirmed and one unrecorded, is the enforcement record.	MOVEMENT
Zambia	The data protection commissioner was asked by nine civil-society organisations to examine a beneficiary contact list, and nothing in the base shows the regulator acting. The regulator exists and travels — it appeared at an international identity event — and nothing in the base shows it acting (commissioner, freedom, engagement). Tenders were opened in August 2026 for a data protection compliance management system and for guidelines consultancy; these are tenders rather than awards, with no value, delivery date or statement of the commission's current caseload or enforcement record held (tender, guidelines). A regulator with no recorded action, procuring the system that would let it record action, is the position.	NO CHANGE
Zimbabwe	721 data controllers were licensed by October 2025 with no figure since, close to 1,200 officers trained, and certification costs US\$1,250 plus a US\$30 application fee per officer. The licensed-controller count has not moved since October 2025 (licensed, institutions), and close to 1,200 officers have been trained (trained). Certification is required of every officer at US\$1,250 plus a US\$30 application fee (certification). Doctors have objected to the levies, the statutory instrument's fee schedule is not held, and no licence count, exemption or regulator response to the objections is on record (objections, critique). Mandatory compliance inspections begin on 1 September 2026; the notice sets a start date and no inspection programme, sanction schedule or first action is published (inspections, crackdown).	MIXED a licensing and certification regime built out while its fees are objected to as a cost that reaches consumers

National data protection readiness

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Algeria	Presidential Decree 26-07 requires security and data-protection structures in every public body, gazetted on 18 January 2026. No such requirement was on record at the window's opening. The decree was signed on 7 January 2026 and gazetted on 18 January, reported as mandating security and data-protection structures in every public body. Commencement is not established from the summary and the operative text is not held, so what a public body must actually stand up, by when, and to whom it answers is not checkable from anything on file. No count of bodies compliant, and no supervisory report, has followed it.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Angola	State surveillance runs without judicial warrant at any stage, and no rule states when the intelligence service may obtain identity, biometric or mobility data. The surveillance regime has been in force since April 2020: cellular location and electronic surveillance are authorised in writing by the public prosecutor, or by the head of the police body in urgent cases with notice within 72 hours, with no judicial warrant at any stage and execution running 90 days renewable. Private persons and businesses must open their own video-surveillance systems to the criminal police, and the data-protection authority is given knowledge and monitoring of the resulting police database rather than authorisation over it. Alongside it, video-surveillance installations are licensed by the minister responsible for public security and recordings are erased at 30 days unless a criminal-police or judicial body has requested them. 2026-08-15 — a civil-society report documents what is missing: no rule for intelligence access to identity, biometric or mobility data, no independent review of such requests, and a border-control system budgeted at US\$112m and awarded directly, where the one functional post has discontinued fingerprint capture. The only evidence of use on file is a forensic confirmation that an intelligence service acquired commercial spyware and infected a journalist's phone.	NO CHANGE the gaps newly documented rather than closed
Benin	The authority had new members designated on 1 July 2026 and reports 907 files, 64 control missions and 14 sanctioned cases. 2026-07-01 — the Council of Ministers designated the authority's new members, including its presidency and representatives of the National Assembly, the Bar and the judiciary. 2026-06-25 — the authority reports 907 files, 64 control missions and 14 sanctioned cases. No algorithmic-audit tooling or dedicated budget is stated for it, so readiness is a caseload rather than a capability.	MOVEMENT
Botswana	The Data Protection Act 2024 is in force and the commission is taking and investigating complaints. 2024-10-29 — the Act was gazetted, repealing the 2018 statute and continuing the Information and Data Protection Commission. 2026-02-02 — the commissioner confirmed the commission is receiving and empowered to investigate complaints of unlawful processing, as the public service began harmonising employee privacy notices and issued a standard data-subject-rights form. No figure for complaints received, staffing or budget is published.	MOVEMENT
Burkina Faso	The non-profit register gained a retention period for the first time, while an electronic travel form centralised border data for risk profiling with no retention rule stated. 2026-07-23 — the non-profit register decree was replaced under a 2024 anti-money-laundering law, fixing for the first time a retention period for the data it holds after dissolution and adding donation declarations and intervention-theme fields. A surveillance register acquiring a data lifecycle is a real improvement, and it is the only retention rule this ledger records. 2026-04-08 — against it, airport embarkation and disembarkation forms moved online, with the border-police director stating that centralised data opens intelligence uses including movement analysis, anomaly detection and risk profiling, and neither account states a retention rule or an access control. The pattern runs through this whole report: collection instruments arrive with stated analytical purposes and no stated limits, and the supervisor that would test them is mid-merger with no enforcement decrees behind it.	MIXED a surveillance register gained a retention rule while a new border data collection launched with none
Burundi	A first personal data protection law was promulgated on 10 March 2026, replacing a position in which no legal regime for personal data existed. 2025-10-22 — the Council of Ministers adopted the draft law, recording the government's own position that the collection and processing of personal data in Burundi had no legal framework or regime at that date. 2026-01-15 — the National Assembly adopted the bill unanimously in plenary, the same account recording that the biometric national identity card process was under way in twelve pilot zones. 2026-03-10 — Loi n 1/03 was promulgated and published by the regulator on 18 March. The official text is an image-only scan with no text layer, so the base can state that a law exists and cannot yet state what it requires — including whether it carries any cross-border transfer or localisation rule. No supervisory authority, commencement date or implementing regulation is held.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Cameroon	Personal-data systems multiplied with no supervisor: a private address register entered the identity stack and a driver-monitoring system was presented with no regime published. 2025-06-19 - a bank partnership required every new customer to supply a geolocated postal address certified through a startup's postal-operator tie-up, reaching more than 700,000 clients of that bank, at FCFA 2,000 a certification - a privately run register entering the identity-verification stack without a legislative act. 2026-05 - a driver-behaviour monitoring system was presented and awarded at the first national road-safety forum, with no deployment scale, contract, fleet count or data-protection regime published. Both process personal data in volume in a year in which the authority that would supervise them was not established.	REGRESSED
Cape Verde	The judicial police still have no effective access to the national video-surveillance system, two years after a formal request. A formal request was made to the Interior Minister in mid-2024 and the force had no effective access. 2026-05-13 - the claim was restated by the national director at the force's 33rd anniversary with still no access granted, the Justice Minister calling it justified and saying steps were under way with the Interior Ministry, which manages the system, alongside expansion projects in several cities and islands. No legal basis, safeguard or data-protection opinion on inter-institutional image sharing is held. A surveillance estate now being extended under a third financed phase, with no published rule on who may see it, is the readiness position.	NO CHANGE
Central African Republic	A critical account reported the president turning to mobile operators to trace citizens through SIM card records (report). A critical account reported the president turning to mobile operators to trace citizens through SIM card records (report). No official instrument authorising it is held, and no data-protection safeguard is named in the account.	REGRESSED
Comoros	The law is in force with sixty-eight articles; the commission it creates has never been stood up. The statute's own text is now on file and settles what the regime is: article 19 institutes a Commission nationale de l'informatique et des libertes to see the law applied, article 6 bars processing of political, religious, trade-union, health and sexual-life data without express consent, and article 67 gave the state one year and everyone else six months to comply. It closes on its adoption in plenary session on 26 June 2014. The commission does not exist. Its creation is a stand-up consultancy financed under the e-government project, with submissions open to March 2027. The one thing that moved is upstream of the law: a national data governance strategy validated in August 2026, unpublished and unadopted.	MIXED a data governance strategy reached validation while the supervisory commission the 2014 law creates is still not constituted
Congo	The data protection commission's members were appointed by decree gazetted on 29 January 2026, seven years after the statute provided for it. Decret 2025-538 names the members of the Commission nationale pour la protection des donnees a caractere personnel, drawn from the Presidency, Parliament, Government, the judiciary, the Cour des comptes, the bar, the national human rights commission and non-governmental organisations. Loi 29-2019 had provided for a supervisory authority since 2019. Loi 43-2020 separately authorised ratification of the African Union Convention on Cyber Security and Personal Data Protection, deposited on 23 October 2020. The legal half is settled and the institutional half has only just been constituted: no registration, notification, deliberation, guidance note or enforcement action under the law is held.	MOVEMENT
Cote d'Ivoire	A compliance platform is live and being taken sector by sector, while the regulator's position on mobile-money agents copying identity documents is unstated. Compliance moved off paper. The platform is live with online submission, real-time tracking and traceability for personal-data conformity, processing authorisations and video-surveillance authorisations, the regulator's communiqué of 3 August directs all data controllers, correspondents and advisory firms onto it, and it was presented to insurers on 17 August 2026 after banking and financial institutions. No post-launch throughput figure, cut-off for paper filings, compliance deadline or fee schedule is published. And the mobile-money agents' union put four questions to the regulator on 24 July 2026 on whether kiosk agents may demand, photograph or retain customer identity documents, with no response on file.	MIXED an online compliance platform went live and is being taken sector by sector while a question on agents handling identity documents is unanswered

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Djibouti	Body-worn cameras are in routine police use with no retention period, access rule, data controller or authorising instrument published. The cameras were not on record at the window's opening. They are now described as standard issue for the national police and road-safety officers, in routine use in central Djibouti with visible wearing and notification protocols and manual or automatic triggers. The account is the state daily's and is framed as reassurance. No retention period, access rule, data controller or authorising instrument is published, and no prior authorisation for the fleet is on record under the regime the Digital Code requires for biometric processing. A biometric-capable surveillance capability entering routine use while its supervisor cannot be shown to exist is the readiness position.	REGRESSED
DR Congo	A drone and citizen-reporting deployment runs in Kinshasa through a private company, and a ministry memorandum names digital identity in scope. 2026-01 - a drone surveillance and citizen-reporting deployment was reported, operated through a private company, with the reporting outlet itself raising privacy and operator-integrity concerns and no procurement value, legal basis, data-retention rule or oversight arrangement held. 2026-08-13 - the digital economy ministry signed a memorandum with a commercial bank to modernise financial services and accelerate banking inclusion, covering digital identity and artificial-intelligence integration, with no term, value, workplan or data-protection provision published. Both process personal data, neither states a safeguard, and no supervisor exists to ask.	REGRESSED
Egypt	Rights organisations called for withdrawal of the directives making biometric verification a condition of holding a mobile line. 2026-08-24 - organisations called on the regulator to withdraw the directives making biometric verification a condition of registering, managing or recovering a mobile line, arguing that the regulator has published neither an account of where registration failed nor any assessment of whether the operators it referred to prosecution on 10 August can protect biometric data; the objection was also put by a senator. No regulatory instrument, retention rule or operator-side safeguard is held. Parliament is meanwhile arguing for instruments that already exist: a member demanded a comprehensive digital-privacy bill without referencing the 2020 law at any point, and another proposed a national register letting citizens see which bodies have processed their data, arguing the 2020 law needs enforcement rather than replacement.	REGRESSED
Equatorial Guinea	The Chamber of Deputies approved ratifying the regional data protection convention in March 2026; no supervisory authority operates. The domestic law dates from 2016 and its supervisory authority has never been recorded operating. The 2015-2017 package carries the protection and retention rules it would enforce. The external commitment moved first: an interministerial council reviewed a proposal to authorise the convention in November 2025 and the Chamber approved ratification in March 2026, four months before the signing ceremony. Ratifying a convention does not constitute a regulator.	MOVEMENT
Eritrea	No supervisory authority exists and none is provided for; the position was re-verified in August 2026 (redetermination). The August 2026 verification pass records no comprehensive data-protection law, no supervisory authority and no published enforcement decisions (redetermination). The only body with sector-supervision power is the Communication Department, which a trade regulatory profile describes as having little to no decision-making authority (profile). The nearest legal anchor is the privacy article of the 1997 Constitution, which has never been brought into force (legal status). Readiness here is not partial: there is no law, no regulator and no route to redress.	NO CHANGE

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Eswatini	Advisory guidelines on health data went to validation workshops, sector guidelines were validated over a week, and biometric gate passes were deployed in schools without ministry approval. Health-data guidelines opened validation workshops in July 2026 (health), and sector guidelines were validated at a week-long workshop in August; no breach count, penalty or enforcement action is published behind the regulator's ranking, and the draft guidelines are not held (sector). Some public schools deployed biometric gate passes without education ministry approval, charging about E200 per pupil (schools). Guidelines being validated at sector level while individual schools are already collecting children's biometrics for a fee, unapproved, is the gap between the regime being written and the practice on the ground.	MOVEMENT
Ethiopia	No independent impact assessment, redress mechanism or statutory limit on state access to the identity system is held, against 46.5m registrations. A published critique argues the identity system risks becoming an instrument of mass profiling in the absence of independent data-protection impact assessments, meaningful citizen rights and legal limits on state access (critique). In August 2026 the foreign ministry circulated a note asking every accredited diplomatic mission and international organisation to submit lists and addresses of all Ethiopian and foreign employees without diplomatic privileges, together with tenant and landlord details (diplomatic note). No legal basis, retention rule, data controller or purpose limitation is stated in the note as reported. The regulator now says the secondary law is coming: four directives are expected to be approved in the coming months and a registration portal for data controllers and processors has been previewed, an early step towards a national register of them. The directives are unpublished, the portal was shown at a workshop co-hosted with a vendor, and a year after the proclamation took effect nothing has been enforced under it.	REGRESSED
Gabon	Article 75 prohibits biometric processing outright and article 76 cross-references its derogation to the wrong article, leaving the route defective. The prohibition is absolute on the face of the statute, and the derogation that would open it points to the article on children's data rather than to the prohibition it is meant to qualify (Loi n 025/2023). That is recorded as a defect in the gazetted text rather than read as intended, and it stands unamended against an identity card, a biometric civil registry and an airport passenger-data system all in operation.	NO CHANGE an outright biometric prohibition standing with its own derogation route defective
Gambia	A State Intelligence Service Bill validated in July 2026 is reported to require judicial warrants and oversight for intrusive measures. It would also give the National Assembly review of the Service's budgets and operations; it has not been tabled (validation). The text is not held and the Bill does not appear in the Assembly's bills library, so the provisions are as reported from a workshop. It is the only instrument in the base that would put a limit on state access to personal data, and it exists as an account of a draft.	MOVEMENT
Ghana	An amendment sent to Parliament would grant security agencies defined access to the biometric citizen database and place the identity agency under the interior ministry. The amendment was reported sent to Parliament in August 2025 (amendment). The base carries nothing after that date despite the civil-liberties objections it drew, so neither passage nor withdrawal is established, and the access it would create has no published safeguard, oversight body or logging requirement attached to it.	REGRESSED

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Guinea	The statute is in force with processing principles, data subject rights and a prior-authorisation regime for transfers outside the region, and the authority it provides for has never been constituted. The text is held from the National Assembly's own publication: it sets definitions, processing principles and data subject rights including erasure, restriction and portability, repeatedly assigns functions to a personal data protection authority to be created by regulation, defines a third country as a non-regional state and makes transfers there subject to prior authorisation. The capture stops mid-article. Readiness is the gap between that text and its machinery. There is no constituted authority, no appointed members and no organising decree, so nothing authorises a transfer, hears a complaint or issues a sanction. 2026-06 - what has been built instead is awareness: the cybersecurity agency launched a national campaign, training magistrates, judges, court officers and judicial police on cybercrime, digital evidence and chain of custody, and running student sessions on phishing, account protection, digital identity and personal data protection. Capacity building does not staff an authority.	MOVEMENT
Guinea-Bissau	Readiness rests on a draft policy decree and an agency still only committed to, with no enacted statute behind either. The base holds no data protection statute for Guinea-Bissau. What it holds instead is a policy decree approved in draft on 10 July 2025 and not confirmed in force, and an agency committed to in January 2025 and not confirmed established. Neither moved in the twelve months to 2026-08-26. No registration or notification regime, no data subject rights case, no enforcement action and no cross-border transfer rule appears on the ledger. The biometric identity network, the civil registry digitisation and the electoral register update reported elsewhere in this report are all proceeding without any of it, which is what the absence costs.	NO CHANGE
Kenya	Three draft guidance notes issued in July 2026 read the Act onto artificial intelligence, emerging technologies and privacy-enhancing technologies. Three guidance notes issued in July 2026 extend the Act into new ground. The artificial-intelligence note would require a lawful basis and adequacy assessment for offshore transfers, registration of deployers, an impact assessment before high-risk deployment, and lifecycle obligations binding procured systems as tightly as built ones (artificial intelligence note). The others cover the internet of things, cloud, blockchain, biometric recognition classified three ways, extended reality and connected vehicles (emerging technologies), and read privacy-enhancing technologies as a statutory obligation under privacy by design (privacy technologies). None states a commencement or says whether it binds or guides. Draft notes on biometrics and age assurance from May 2025 remain drafts (biometrics and age assurance). Penalties under the Act had passed KES 26 million by October 2024, on a practitioner's tally, not a commissioner's return. The High Court blocked the transport authority from compelling ride-hailing platforms to retain passenger and driver data for three years, finding unconstitutional continuous surveillance in breach of Article 31 and the 2019 Act, and gave the state twelve months to run a regulatory impact assessment and re-align the rules — the clearest instance here of the Act enforced against the state rather than controllers.	MOVEMENT
Lesotho	A US\$364m health agreement with the United States carries data-sharing agreements that have not been published, after a brief release was withdrawn. The agreement was signed in December 2025 and stated at US\$364m (complaint). The State Department published a subset of the memoranda in March 2026 and then removed public access, and the related data-sharing agreements have not been published. Lesotho is one of sixteen countries named in a freedom-of-information suit filed on 2 April 2026 that remains unresolved, and African governments had already pushed back on the health deals over data and power (reporting).	REGRESSED the data-sharing instrument behind a bilateral health agreement was briefly published and then withdrawn
Liberia	A riders' union memorandum would build digital identity, satellite tracking and a rider database for commercial motorcycle operators, with no data-protection basis reported. It was signed in August 2026 between the union and a private digital services company, aimed at curbing vehicle theft and linking informal-sector riders to formal financial and government services (memorandum). It is a private arrangement covering location tracking of a working population: no custodian, retention rule or consent mechanism is reported, and no statutory backing is claimed. It was signed three days before the country's first data-protection statute took effect.	REGRESSED

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Libya	Two databases holding personal records were authorised in August 2026, one of expatriate workers and one of event participants, neither with a stated legal basis. The interior and labour ministries agreed a unified national database of expatriate workers on 3 August 2026, with a dedicated platform and no authorising instrument, retention limit or oversight body named (database). The economy and trade ministry launched an exhibitions and conferences platform on 9 August 2026 building an integrated record of organisers, participants and visitors, with no supplier, hosting arrangement or data-protection basis stated (platform).	REGRESSED two new population-scale databases authorised with no protective framework behind them
Madagascar	The supervisory commission was constituted in August 2025, eleven years after the law that provides for it. The founding statute of December 2014 establishes the data-protection regime and the supervisory authority (statute). Seven members were sworn in at the Supreme Court in August 2025 (swearing-in), and the commission was recorded as operational days later (operationalisation). An operating procedures manual running to 73 pages followed in December 2025, covering session, administrative, data-protection and cooperation procedures (manual), and a first annual report in 2026 (report). No enforcement action, sanction or complaint volume is held.	MOVEMENT
Malawi	Two implementing instruments were published in October 2025 and the general exemption elapsed in June 2026. The Act has been in force since 3 June 2024, with the regulator designated data protection authority, and its general exemption for controllers and processors elapsed in early June 2026 so that all are now within scope. 2025-10 - two instruments were published: regulations on the engagement of data processors on 17 October and guidelines on personal data breach notifications on 22 October, with a compliance guideline and checklist alongside. The authority is a unit inside the regulator with a named head and no published organogram, enforcement record or registration data. Rules exist; no enforcement under them does.	MOVEMENT
Mali	The authority authorised the demobilisation commissions to process ex-combatant data, and has a mandatory lease-declaration decree in draft. The national health insurance body completed a digital security training dedicated to data protection (report). The two national demobilisation and integration commissions were authorised to collect and process ex-combatant and beneficiary data, and ran a three-day training on personal-data protection in domestic law covering it in August 2026; the authorisation's scope, retention period and the number of records held are not published (authorisation). A draft decree making lease declaration mandatory was before the authority in October 2025 and no adoption is on record (decree). Prior authorisation of a named sensitive processing is the strongest readiness signal the base holds for the country.	MOVEMENT
Mauritania	The 2017 data protection law is being issued under: deliberations of 2025 set rules for transfers abroad and for foreign cloud services. Deliberation 004/2025 sets the conditions and procedural rules for transferring personal data abroad with a list of countries treated as adequate (transfers), and the amended text of deliberation 005/2025, published 30 April 2026, requires prior authorisation for processing personal data through cloud services abroad and contractual guarantees covering return of the data on expiry and its permanent deletion by the provider (cloud). The authority meets monthly with minutes issued, working on the inspection framework and its sworn agents (inspections) and on hosting inside the country (hosting), against a published strategic plan for 2023-2026. No budget, staffing, caseload or sanction figure is published, so activity is dated and capacity is not. The amended text does not state which articles changed from the original.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Mauritius	Interception described in Parliament as running since 2017 without judicial oversight has no reform instrument, and an airport plate-recognition system was installed with no retention rule published. Large-scale interception was described in Parliament as running since 2017 without judicial oversight, wired into major operators and accessed by counter-terrorism and national security units; no reform instrument, inquiry outcome or judicial-authorisation requirement has been published, and leaked recordings continue to test the framework (interception, leaks). An airport parking system with more than twenty licence-plate-recognition cameras entered full operation in August 2026 at a cost of Rs 50 million, replacing a 2013 installation; no retention period, data controller or privacy assessment is published (system).	REGRESSED large-scale interception still running without judicial oversight while a new plate-recognition system was installed on public premises with no privacy assessment
Morocco	Smart patrol vehicles carrying live facial recognition entered service in Rabat in July 2026, five years into a case-by-case authorisation regime whose public-highway question is still open. The commission replaced a lapsed moratorium with a case-by-case prior-authorisation regime at the end of 2020, conditioning future authorisation on routing through a national trusted-third-party identity system and flagging controllers building their own biometric databases, sometimes hosted abroad (regime). It decided hearings on video surveillance in March 2025 and had published no deliberation by August 2026, treating facial recognition on the public highway as an open question (hearings). Patrol vehicles with live facial recognition, automated number-plate reading and in-vehicle access to the central database entered field service in Rabat in the week of 20 July 2026, with two further cities announced; neither held account cites a data-protection authorisation, a legal basis, a retention rule or an oversight mechanism (patrols, account).	REGRESSED live facial recognition entered field service with no authorisation, legal basis or retention rule cited in either account held
Mozambique	A personal-data breach reporting platform has taken reports since February 2026, operating with no data-protection statute behind it. The platform launched as a pilot in February 2026 and takes reports of personal-data breaches, illicit content and cyber incidents (platform, update). No reporting volumes and no exit-from-pilot date are on record. A breach-reporting channel without a statute defining a breach, a controller's duty or a sanction is a useful thing built in the wrong order, and it is the country's only operating data-protection mechanism.	MOVEMENT
Namibia	The Data Protection Bill was promised for September 2025 and was still in final polishing in January 2026; a breach in October showed what the gap costs. The ministry's budget motivation of May 2025 recorded the Bill still pending discussion in the Cabinet Committee before tabling that financial year (motivation), and in August the ministry said it would table it in September (tabling). In January 2026 the minister described the data protection and cybercrime bills as under final polishing, with consultation on the cybercrime bill opening on 2 February (polishing). In between, the students' financial assistance fund was breached and the national incident response team's head called for urgent finalisation of the law (breach). The last version of the Bill the base holds in full is the revised draft of March 2022. Four years of drafting, one breach and no statute.	STALLED
Niger	The law and the treaty commitment stand; the authority that enforced them was suppressed in June 2026. Readiness here went backwards during the window, and the law is not what moved. The consolidated 2022 data protection law remains in force as amended by a 2023 law and two 2024 ordinances, carrying declaration duties, restrictions on fully automated decisions and profiling, and inspection, authorisation and sanction powers. Niger has also ratified the continental convention. What was removed is the institution. The protection authority was suppressed in June 2026, a year after its president had set out how the law was being applied. Every duty the statute creates now runs to a body that does not exist, and no successor is named on the base.	REGRESSED

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Nigeria	A circular directs every federal agency to appoint data protection officers, and its own text is not in the public record; a suit was filed against the electoral commission for operating without a privacy policy. The circular directs all ministries, departments and agencies to appoint qualified officers and register them, engage licensed compliance organisations, make budgetary provision and file audit returns, and makes permanent secretaries and chief executives personally responsible; it is the first instrument on file pointing the Act's enforcement apparatus at the public sector rather than at banks, schools and telcos, and searches of the government's own resource portal returned nothing three days after the announcement (circular). A Federal High Court suit was filed against the electoral commission for operating without a website privacy policy, following an exposé and a voter-record leak (suit). The commission has a memorandum with the communications regulator (memorandum) and agreed collaboration with the securities regulator with no joint supervisory arrangement stated (collaboration), while artificial-intelligence-generated identity fraud rose 192 per cent in one quarter as document forgery fell 80 (fraud).	MIXED the Act's enforcement apparatus pointed at the public sector for the first time while the instrument doing it is not published
Rwanda	A registration regime for controllers and processors has run since the 2021 law, and the authority's own framing is that registration is the beginning rather than the end. The regime has been live since the law and the authority itself says registration is where compliance starts (regime). A civil-society privacy scorecard, in its fifth edition, is the other measure the base holds, and it carries no country-specific figure for 2024 (scorecard). Between a registration count that measures enrolment rather than practice and a scorecard with no figure for this country, readiness here is asserted more than it is measured.	NO CHANGE
Sao Tome and Principe	The 2016 law creates the supervisory authority, which has since taken supervision of a live interoperability project and joined two international networks. The statutory basis is now held in its own gazette text rather than through a secondary survey (law). The authority was assigned to supervise the civil-registry to electoral-database interconnection in April 2026 (supervision), is a founding member of a Lusophone data-protection network (network), and signed a cooperation memorandum with a Macau counterpart in June 2026 (memorandum). Readiness in the sense the indicator asks about is thinner than the activity: no register of controllers, no published finding, no penalty and no annual report appears at any date.	MOVEMENT
Senegal	A national online child-protection action plan was put in place on nine axes, and the plan itself is unpublished. The telecommunications ministry put the plan in place on nine axes, the named mechanisms being a focal-point network, a rapid reporting system, digital education in schools and campaigns in national languages (plan). The plan is unpublished, so the axes are known only through the description of them. It is the only protective instrument in this unit that reached implementation during the window, against a data-protection law still under revision.	MOVEMENT
Sierra Leone	Data protection by design training was delivered to the state technical team, while police requests for subscriber data are answered with no warrant requirement or oversight mechanism on the record. The training was delivered in August 2026, and no curriculum, attendance figure or follow-on compliance requirement is published (training). An operator answers police requests for subscriber verification data, and no warrant requirement, oversight mechanism or reporting duty governing those disclosures is on the record (disclosures). Training the builders while the disclosure route is ungoverned is the shape of readiness here: the design principle is being taught and the statutory basis does not exist.	MOVEMENT
Somalia	The regulator asked a messaging platform to delay usernames, on grounds of impersonation risk to mobile money and loss of phone-number traceability. The request was made in a regulator statement in July 2026 and restated by the minister later that month (request). The stated grounds are impersonation risk against the mobile-money system and loss of phone-number traceability in the campaign against an armed group. Both are traceability arguments, which is a state asking a platform not to reduce the identifiability of its users. No response from the platform, legal basis for the request or outcome is on record.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
South Africa	The regulator set out new enforcement signals (briefing) in a month when a nine-month credential exposure surfaced (report). The Information Regulator set out enforcement signals for data-protection and access-to-information compliance at a briefing on 31 August 2026 (briefing). Stealer-log analysis found a fast-food chain's customer credentials exposed for about nine months through its web self-service portals, 13 of the 23 records being customer accounts (report). 2026-08-31 — the regulator reported more than 8,000 security-compromise reports to date and 1,220 since April, roughly 244 a month, projected to pass 3,000 for the year and called "very alarming"; its assessments find the public sector putting less effort than the private into appropriate security measures. 2026-04-14 — quarterly figures put breaches at roughly 263 a month in the first quarter of 2026 against about 284 a month over April to November 2025. The rate has eased across all three periods held while the cumulative total has not. Retention practice surfaced through litigation rather than supervision: an operator told the Constitutional Court that it retains only six months of operational data at a time and that no record links a message to any corresponding return call.	MIXED the regulator signalled enforcement while a nine-month credential exposure went unreported
South Sudan	A Data Protection Bill reached version 1.0 and a validation workshop; no statute and no authority exists. Civil society convened the regulator, members of parliament and the UN mission's legal unit over two days in May 2026 to review and validate the bill (workshop). Against that, the regulator's own overview shows the privacy function still sitting inside a telecoms mandate (overview), and a research organisation has argued that what the country needs is a genuinely independent and resourced authority rather than a bill alone (analysis). Readiness here means one drafted bill and one borrowed function. The World Bank's 2026 country diagnostic reaches the same place from outside: no comprehensive data-protection law, no established data-protection agency, limited cybersecurity capacity, and government data sharing conducted on informal memorandums (diagnostic). The absence is not new — a rights monitor recorded no law and no appointed authority as far back as May 2022 (factsheet).	MOVEMENT
Sudan	A central bank directive suspends bank accounts whose customer data is not updated, its deadline extended to end-2026, with no exception for displaced customers without documents. The directive requires customer data to be updated on pain of account suspension, and the deadline was extended to the end of 2026 (directive, extension). The directive text is not held. No count of accounts affected, no exception for displaced customers without documents and no appeal route is stated anywhere (flexibility). In a country where displacement is mass, a rule that conditions keeping a bank account on producing identity documents is an exclusion instrument whether or not it is meant as one, and nothing published measures who it excludes. The country has no data-protection statute in force under which a customer could contest the processing.	REGRESSED
Tanzania	39,117 numbers were blocked for registration fraud against 56 incident reports to the police — blocking is not prosecution. The regulator gave full-year and quarterly enforcement figures to parliament in August 2026 (enforcement, joint response, fraud). Fifty-six incident reports stand against 39,117 numbers blocked (figures), and no conviction or restitution figure is held. Administrative disconnection in those numbers, with prosecution three orders of magnitude below it, is the shape of enforcement rather than a gap in reporting.	MOVEMENT
Togo	The authority moved from constitution to operation, opening an online declaration platform and training the first data-protection correspondents. Its organisation and powers were fixed by decret n 2020-111/PR of 9 December 2020 — status, missions, control and inspection powers, and competence to issue recommendations, guidelines and reference frameworks including prior risk assessment. On 27 March 2026 it put the statutory declaration of video-surveillance systems onto an online platform with an electronic receipt and a regulatory pictogram, its first compliance procedure operated in its own right. On 22 June 2026 it trained the first 35 data-protection correspondents from public and private bodies, dating the point at which the function became an operating layer rather than a statutory provision. The interview that dates its effective start of activity puts it at March 2025.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Tunisia	No legal basis is held for the linked national health dataset joining health, civil-status, social-affairs and education records; the ministry asserts only that data is stored confidentially and securely. What is missing is a decree, ministerial order or data-sharing instrument stating the basis, retention rule and supervisory authority for that dataset (basis). The dataset it would govern is live: the national health identifier is the repurposed vaccination identifier, the health portal has passed technical validation and a cybersecurity audit, and a digital birth declaration is running at one hospital. An assertion of confidentiality is not a legal basis, and the statute that would supply one is the 2004 law the government is replacing.	NO CHANGE
Uganda	The revenue authority issued more than 1,000 compliance notices for bank customer information since June 2026, and an editorial argues the identity number is handed over on request to security guards and others with no lawful basis. The demands are made under the tax procedures statute and are set by the paper against the data-protection Act; the revenue authority was unavailable for comment and no determination by the protection office is held (notices). Public grasp of data-protection principles was cited at an awareness-campaign launch, and an editorial states the identity-number problem as a lived one rather than a survey finding (grasp, editorial). A three-year child online-safety campaign was launched in August 2026 (children).	REGRESSED
Zambia	The Commissioner names registration as the first step and weak internal systems and limited awareness as continuing gaps. Act No. 3 of 2021 establishes the Office of the Data Protection Commissioner and, at sections 70 and 71, the cross-border transfer regime. 2026-06 – the Data Protection Commissioner went on record identifying registration of controllers as the necessary first step, and naming weak internal systems and limited awareness as continuing implementation gaps. A regulator publicly naming its own enforcement obstacles is a more useful record than a compliance statistic, and it is the only one available: no registration count, no enforcement notice and no penalty under the Act is held, five years after it was passed.	MOVEMENT
Zimbabwe	A National Child Online Protection Policy 2026-2030 was approved by Cabinet with the text not held, and the anti-corruption commission set out investigations into cyber-enabled fraud in state digital systems. The policy text is not held, and no reporting route, responder training programme or budget line for it is on record (policy); an earlier policy of the same name was reported established alongside the cybersecurity strategy on the minister's claim, relayed by one outlet (earlier). The fraud figures are the commission chair's, given at a conference; no charge sheet, audit report or system-remediation record is held for any of the three systems (investigations). A privacy responsibility challenge was launched by the regulator, reaching the base at two-month date precision through a recurring round-up (challenge).	MOVEMENT

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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